

How to analyze the player experience of any game

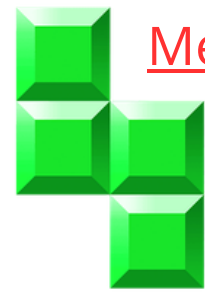
The **player experience** is how the player feels,
thinks or reacts while playing the game



This can't be directly analyzed from any single system.



Goals



Mechanics

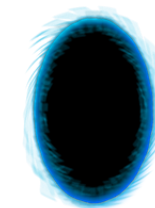


Pacing

Instead, it's deduced from analyzing how players answer and react to the relationship between any two disciplines from that game.



Agency.



Visuals



Characters

Mechanics

Social

Goals

Pacing

Imagine inspecting the disciplines of



Narrative

Audio

Agency

Visuals

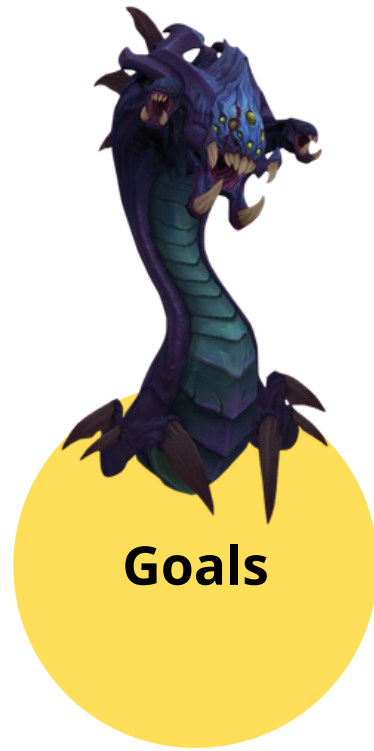


You could take any 2 disciplines





+300

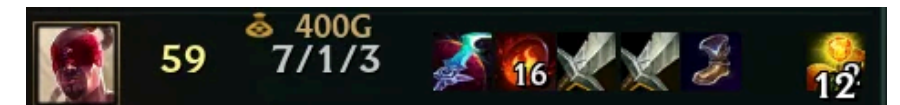


Goals

Inspect them...



Pacing



Goals



Pacing

And then think of any question(s) based on how these two disciplines could affect each other:

Goals

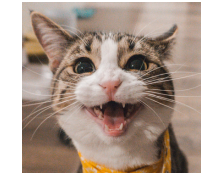


Does the game's pacing give the player the right opportunities to pursue their goals?



Pacing

If players answer yes, you should be



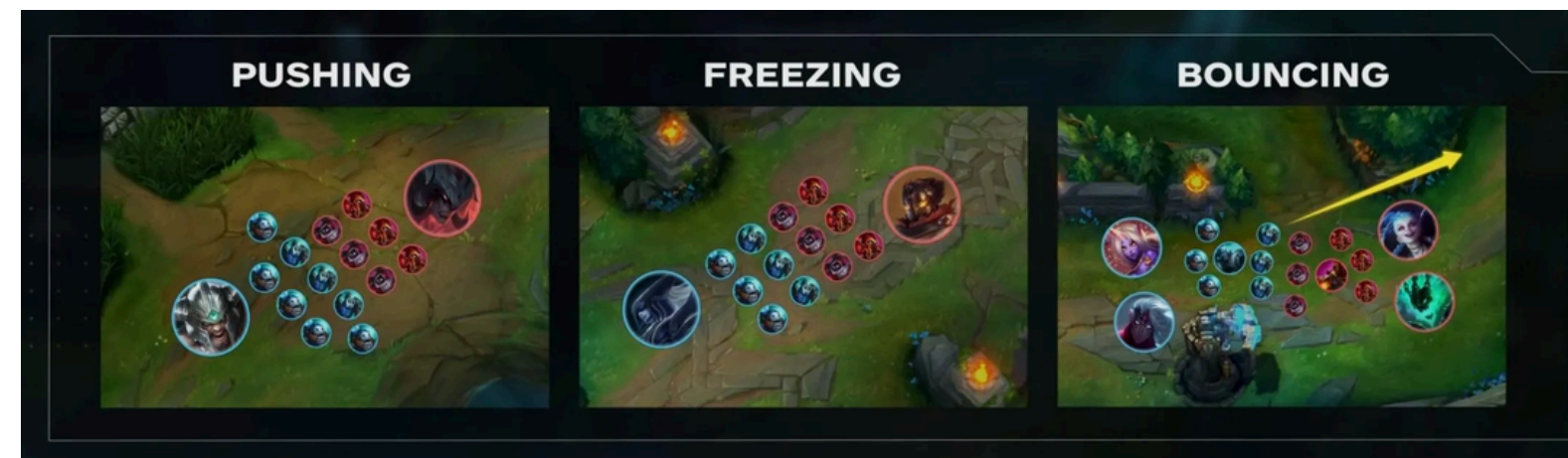
If players don't seem to care about this interaction, nobody cares

If the answer is anything else, you still have work to do

Goals

Does the game's pacing give the player the right opportunities to pursue their goals?

Pacing



Another example:
(1/5)

Mechanics



Do the mechanics create the intended pacing?

Pacing

And another:
(2/5)

Mechanics



Do the mechanics and their visuals align?

Visuals

Mechanics

More...
(3/5)

Mechanics

Goals

- Does the game reward the player for reaching their goals? -

Pacing

Visuals

Agency

Do the mechanics create meaningful gameplay choices?



Goals

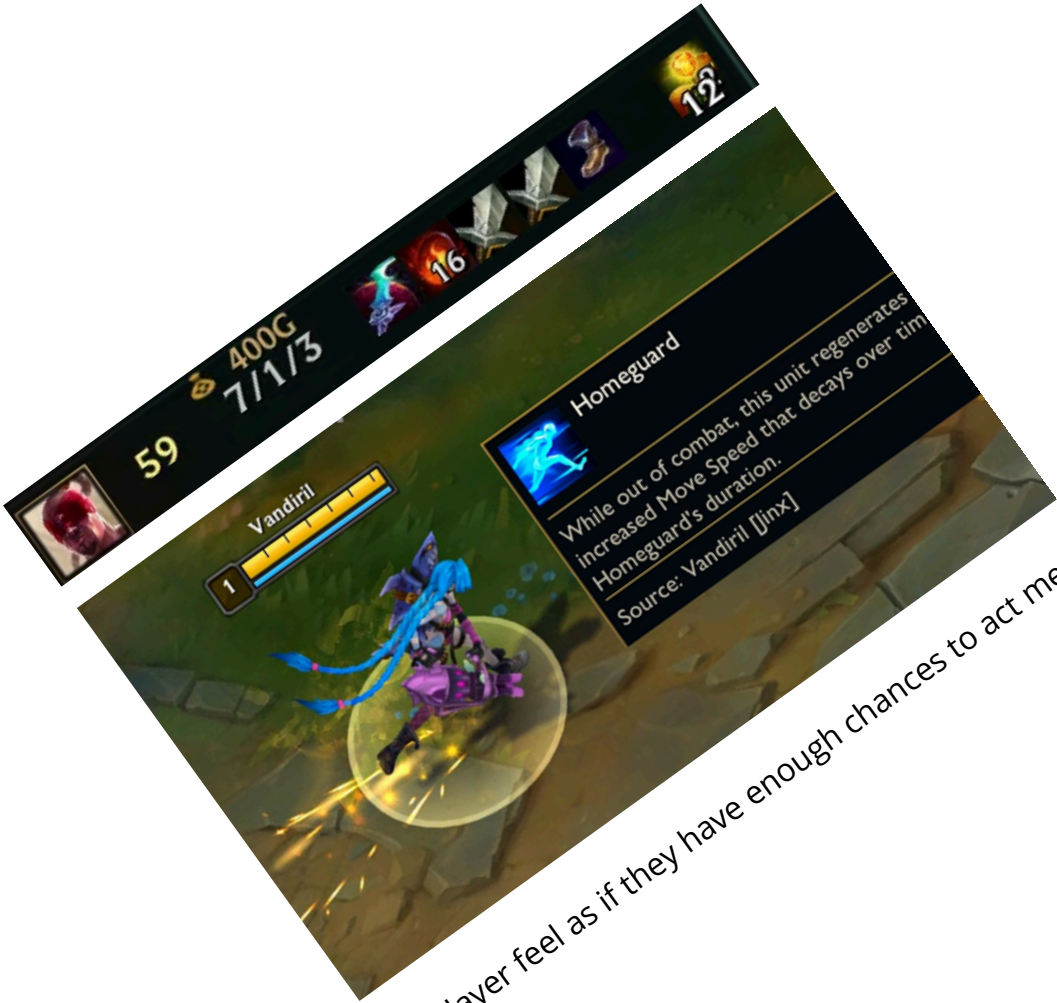
Do the visuals communicate what matters?



Visuals

Pacing

Does the player feel as if they have enough chances to act meaningfully?



Agency

Does the player have agency over their character or world's visuals?

Visuals



Zzzzzzz
(5/5)

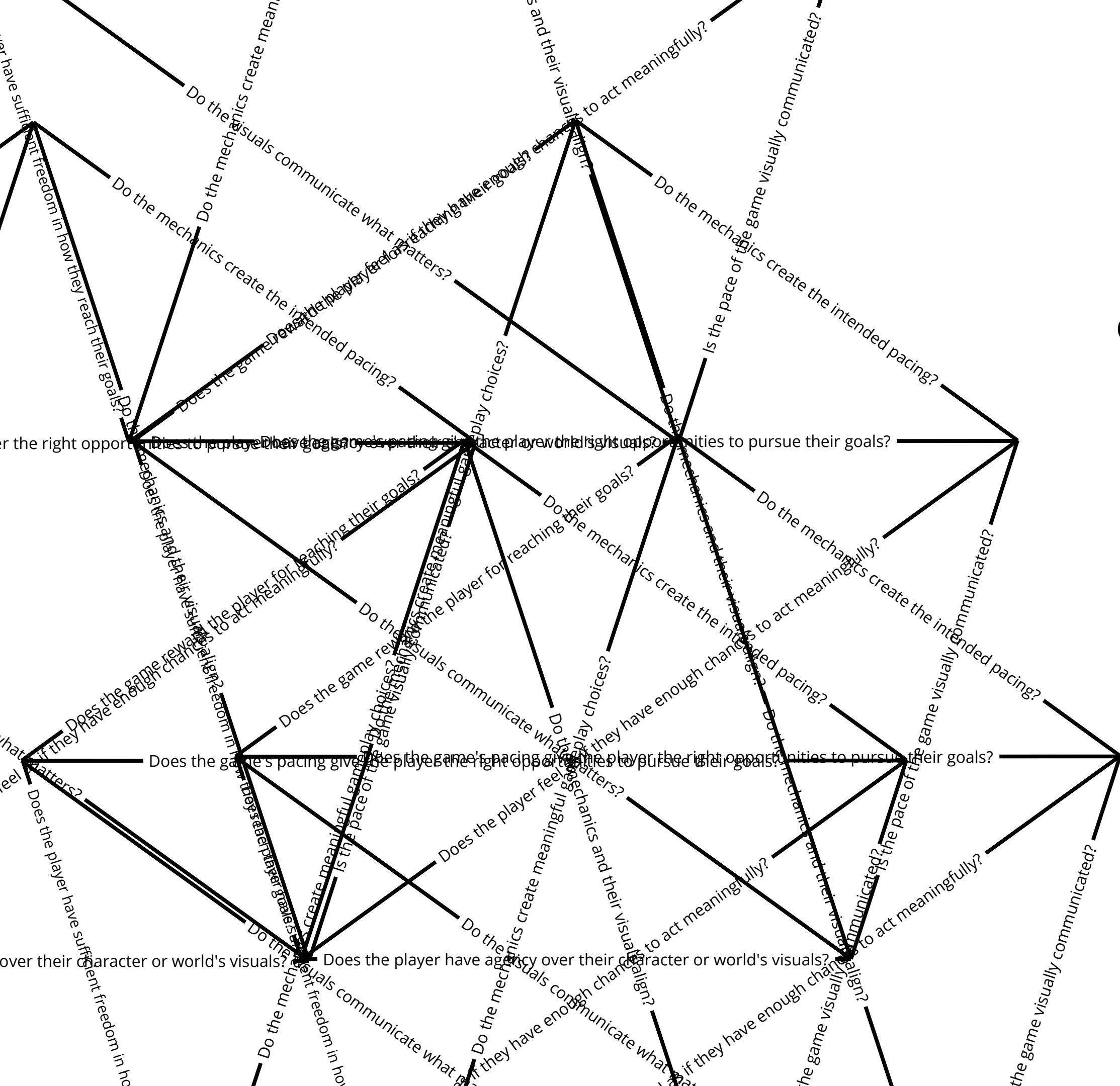


Goals

Does the player have sufficient freedom in how they reach their goals?

Agency



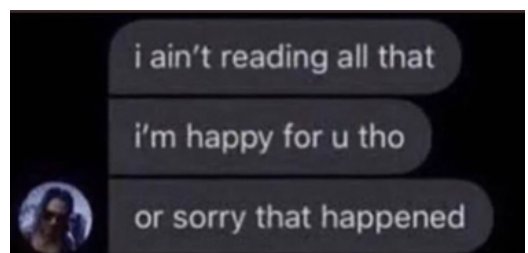


Now, all you have to do is ask that question around a gazillion times for every possible interaction that could be created by two or possibly more disciplines, and then you'll understand the game's player experience!

No. Basically:

I think it's impossible to **fully**, or even **partly**, analyze the player experience for (most) games, because games are just too complex.

The most we can do, is analyze a handful.
Because nobody aint got time for all that



But then the question becomes, which systems do we analyze?

idk